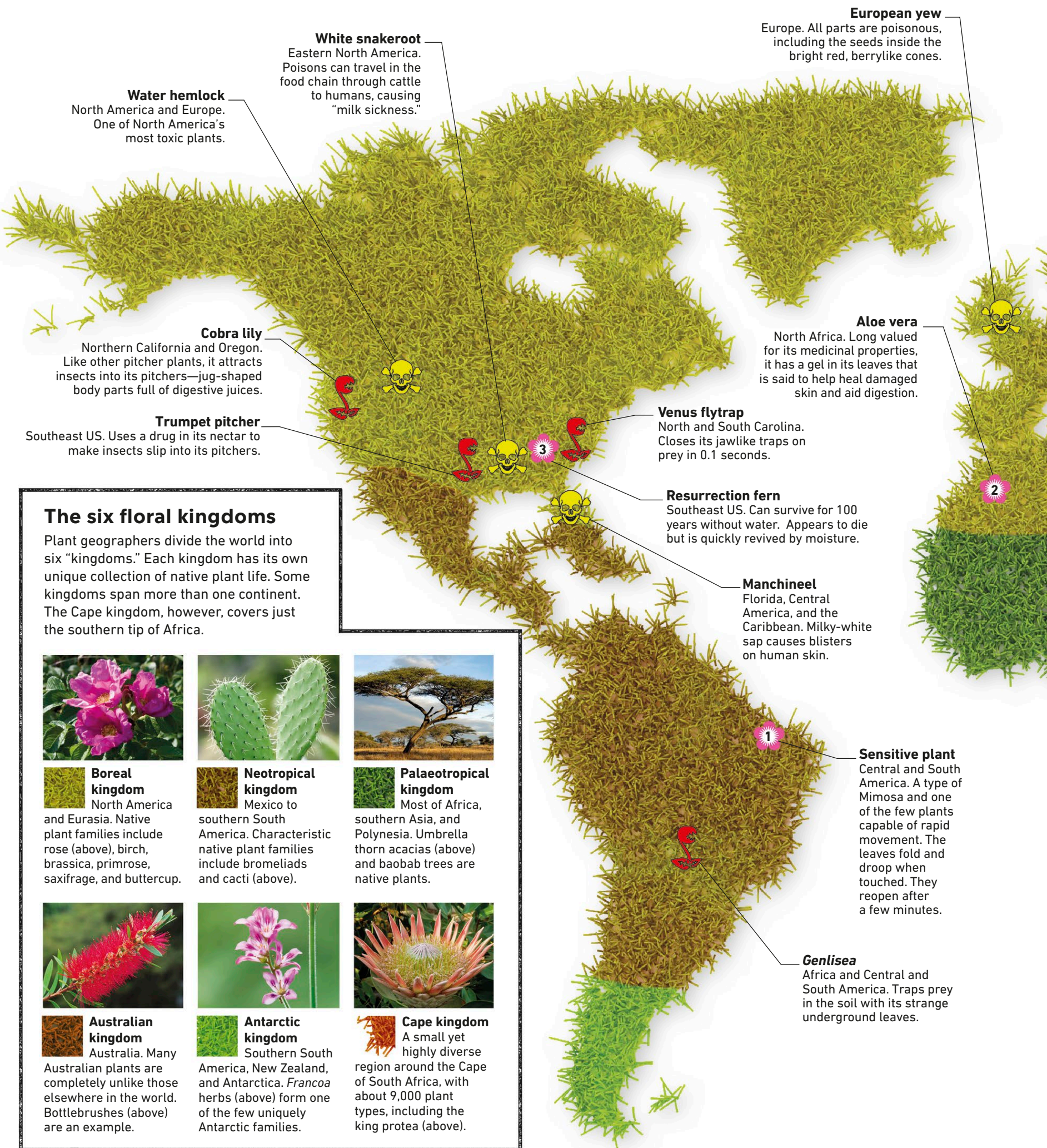




Water hemlock
North America and Europe.
One of North America's
most toxic plants.

White snakeroot
Eastern North America.
Poisons can travel in the
food chain through cattle
to humans, causing
"milk sickness."

European yew
Europe. All parts are poisonous,
including the seeds inside the
bright red, berrylike cones.

Aloe vera
North Africa. Long valued
for its medicinal properties,
it has a gel in its leaves that
is said to help heal damaged
skin and aid digestion.

Cobra lily
Northern California and Oregon.
Like other pitcher plants, it attracts
insects into its pitchers—jug-shaped
body parts full of digestive juices.

Trumpet pitcher
Southeast US. Uses a drug in its nectar to
make insects slip into its pitchers.

Venus flytrap
North and South Carolina.
Closes its jawlike traps on
prey in 0.1 seconds.

Resurrection fern
Southeast US. Can survive for 100
years without water. Appears to die
but is quickly revived by moisture.

Manchineel
Florida, Central
America, and the
Caribbean. Milky-white
sap causes blisters
on human skin.

Sensitive plant
Central and South
America. A type of
Mimosa and one
of the few plants
capable of rapid
movement. The
leaves fold and
droop when
touched. They
reopen after
a few minutes.

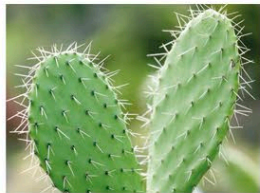
Genlisea
Africa and Central and
South America. Traps prey
in the soil with its strange
underground leaves.

The six floral kingdoms

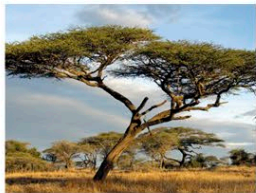
Plant geographers divide the world into
six "kingdoms." Each kingdom has its own
unique collection of native plant life. Some
kingdoms span more than one continent.
The Cape kingdom, however, covers just
the southern tip of Africa.



Boreal kingdom
North America
and Eurasia. Native
plant families include
rose (above), birch,
brassica, primrose,
saxifrage, and buttercup.



Neotropical kingdom
Mexico to
southern South
America. Characteristic
native plant families
include bromeliads
and cacti (above).



Palaeotropical kingdom
Most of Africa,
southern Asia, and
Polynesia. Umbrella
thorn acacias (above)
and baobab trees are
native plants.



Australian kingdom
Australia. Many
Australian plants are
completely unlike those
elsewhere in the world.
Bottlebrushes (above)
are an example.



Antarctic kingdom
Southern South
America, New Zealand,
and Antarctica. *Francoa*
herbs (above) form one
of the few uniquely
Antarctic families.



Cape kingdom
A small yet
highly diverse
region around the Cape
of South Africa, with
about 9,000 plant
types, including the
king protea (above).